

Figure 7. A reservoir on the south side; citadel visible on top

Beyond the City Walls of Dholavira

Further west, past the western wall, lies the city's necropolis with hundreds of unmarked burials. Most are about the same size and contain funerary objects like pots and beads, with some burials a little better endowed than others. However, all but one of the three dozen excavated burials are symbolic or cenotaphs, i.e. without human remains. It's not clear what they did with the bodies. Bisht has proposed that Dholavirans had switched to another method of disposing the dead while still raising memorials. A couple of the burials are architecturally far more elaborate than the others, with more lavish objects. They contain multiple burials added over time in layers, turning it into a mound—perhaps belonging to a set of people related in some way across hundreds of years, whether from a single family or owners of a hereditary title or conferred honour. Due to the absence of